



3 cm/1 1/4 in

BLACK ROCK MOSS
Andreaea rupestris
F: Andreaeaceae

Widespread on mountains, this dark-coloured moss grows on bare rock. Unlike most mosses, its capsules release their spores through four microscopic slits.



3 cm/1 1/4 in

FIRE MOSS
Ceratodon purpureus
F: Ditrichaceae

Found worldwide, particularly on burned or disturbed ground, this low-growing moss is also common on roofs and walls. It produces a dense carpet of spore capsules in spring.



2 cm/3/4 in

COMMON POCKET MOSS
Fissidens taxifolius
F: Fissidentaceae

This widespread moss has short, spreading stems bearing two ranks of pointed leaves. It grows in shaded ground and on rocks.



15 cm/6 in

WHITE FORK MOSS
Leucobryum glaucum
F: Dicranaceae

Growing in large, neatly rounded cushions, this woodland moss has a characteristic grey-green hue, turning almost white in dry weather.



5 cm/2 in

MOUNTAIN FORK MOSS
Dicranum montanum
F: Dicranaceae

A moss that forms compact feathery mounds, this lowland species has narrow leaves that curl up when dry, sometimes breaking off to form new plants.



5 cm/2 in

COMMON TAMARISK MOSS
Thuidium tamariscinum
F: Thuidiaceae

Its finely divided "fronds" make this woodland moss resemble a miniature fern. It grows on rotting wood and rocks in Europe and N. Asia.

10 cm
4 in

VELVET FEATHER-MOSS
Brachythecium velutinum
F: Brachytheciaceae

With its much-branched stems, this abundant moss forms creeping mats on dead wood and in poorly drained grass. It has a worldwide range.

spore capsule
with a conical lid

3 cm/1 1/4 in

PURPLE FORK MOSS
Grimmia pulvinata
F: Grimmiaceae

Growing on rocks, roofs, and walls, this widespread moss has leaves that end in long, silvery hairs. Its spore capsules grow on curved stalks.

4 cm
1 1/2 in

SWAN'S NECK THYME MOSS
Mnium hornum
F: Mniaceae

Brilliant green in spring, this is a common woodland moss in Europe and N. America. Each spore capsule has a curved stalk resembling a swan's neck.

3 cm
1 1/4 in

CYPRESS-LEAVED PLAIT MOSS
Hypnum cupressiforme
F: Hypnaceae

This highly variable mat-forming moss has crowded, overlapping leaves. Found worldwide, it is common on rocks and walls, and beneath trees.

10 cm
4 in

OSTRICH-PLUME FEATHER MOSS
Ptilium crista-castrensis
F: Hypnaceae

Found mainly in northern forests, this moss has feather-shaped, symmetrically branched stems, often forming extensive patches below spruces and pines.

80 cm
32 in

GREATER WATER-MOSS
Fontinalis antipyretica
F: Fontinalaceae

A submerged freshwater species, greater water-moss trails from rocks in slow-flowing rivers and streams. It has three rows of keeled, dark green leaves.



1 cm/3/8 in

CAPE THREAD-MOSS
Orthodontium lineare
F: Bryaceae

This moss from the southern hemisphere was introduced to Europe in the early 20th century and has become an invasive species.

25 cm
10 in

BLUNT-LEAVED BOG MOSS
Sphagnum palustre
F: Sphagnaceae

Like its relatives, this peat-forming moss grows on wet ground, and holds large amounts of water. Each stem ends in a flat-topped rosette of small branches.

40 cm
16 in

COMMON HAIR-CAP MOSS
Polytrichum commune
F: Polytrichaceae

This tall, tussock-forming moss is common in wet moorland throughout the northern hemisphere. Its stems are stiff and unbranched, with narrow, pointed leaves.

1.5 cm
1/2 in

BONFIRE MOSS
Funaria hygrometrica
F: Funariaceae

One of the world's most widespread mosses, this mat-forming species is particularly common on disturbed ground and sites of recent fires. Its ripe spore capsules have orange stalks.